(Duffield 2008, pp. 8–10) for populations living in conflict-affected areas. Concomitantly, it points to a shift of landmine use away from primary military objectives to the targeting and protection of infrastructure, private assets, and community spaces.

This chapter argues that communities have adopted the military use of landmines to establish an element of control within an "emerging political complex" (Duffield 2014, p. 231), posing an immutable choice between the protection of their community and possible causation of physical and psychological trauma of the same local population.

In some circumstances, landmine use can be a form of community agency, not only to deal with insecurity but also to assess risks on the community's own terms (Bottomley 2001; KHRG 2008). Often communities are left with an immutable decision between the dangers of landmine use or exposure to other threats. They undertake risk assessments that weigh the risk of landmine use against other threats.

These findings are derived from research gathered as part of two Knowledge, Attitude, and Practices (KAP) surveys, the first representative of a population of 110,000 people across east Bago and Tanintharyi Regions, and Mon, Kayin, and Kayah States who have been directly impacted by landmine accidents. The second was on a population of 100,000 internally displaced persons residing in various locations across northern Shan and Kachin States. The surveys included a series of extensive coordination meetings and interviews with stakeholders, from senior and junior officials in government, ethnic armed groups (EAGs), and CSOs, as well as participant observation of interactions among these groups. A total of seventy semi-structured key informant interviews were conducted, together with 922 interviews with heads of households, and 390 separate and specific interviews with children, aged eight to eighteen (MRE WG 2014, 2015). The Department of Social Welfare, Ministry Social Welfare Relief and Resettlement coordinated the survey on behalf of working group members, with technical input from UNICEF and DanChurchAid.[3]

The chapter also aligns its findings with outcomes from two national processes, the union government reforms since 2011 and the post-Nationwide Ceasefire Agreement (NCA) process, to illustrate how international responses to landmine use in Myanmar have occurred primarily within the frame of a "security-development nexus" (Jacob 2014, p. 393). This has limited current intervention on landmines to technical discussions centred on 'de-mining' and behavioural change.